

SEASON 01 EPISODE 01

What's Your Name

1 **EXT. DOWNTOWN - DAY**

1

A two-footed rabbit SPRINTS down the pavement.

She is running from an invisible predator.

Her name is EVE, and she is really running from an invisible predator.

Down the road are piles of trash, protest signs with corners burned off, bits of ash. A small shoe, a big one.

She runs past it all.

2 **EXT. OUTSKIRTS - DAY**

2

Through tallgrass.

She pushes it all to the side.

3 **EXT. HIGHWAY 96 - DAY**

3

A sign. "YOU'RE LEAVING: TALENS"

And a bus stop.

She emerges from the tallgrass, staring at the bus stop across a highway. A paved, clean highway. Clean, unlike the roads of downtown.

She stops. Looks both ways. Crosses it.

SHE SITS AT THE STOP. ANOTHER SIGN. "OUTBOUND TO: FJORD"

In the distance: the yellow tallgrass. Beyond: short trees. Beyond: small buildings, poking out.

Eve folds her palms neatly on her pants as the headlights of a distant bus approach.

EVE (V.O.)

The world could end in 10,000 years.
Or in a hundred.

The beams grow stronger.

EVE (V.O.)

Will I have kids? Probably not.

The bus appears over her.

EVE (V.O.)

But I want to leave something
behind.

It hisses. Pauses. Then strides away.

EVE (V.O.)
That's why I'm leaving this place,
and all the history I have with it.

No one left at the bus stop.

The motor vrrs into the distance...

Until it's no longer heard.

EVE (V.O.)
Love you sister, and friends. Make
something of yourselves.

CUT TO BLACK.

The muffled sound of a trailer hitting pavement.

FADE TO:

4 INT. LOUIS'S CAR - DAY

4

BELINDA and HENRY, two grizzly bears, face the road.
They're tall from the backseat.

LOUIS and HAZEL sit behind. Little kids without booster
seats.

Louis crosses his arms and stares out into the open sky.

Hazel sucks her lollipop, glancing at all three. She's at
least a few years older than him.

5 EXT. LOUIS'S HOME - DAY

5

A car slides to a stop to a shoddy, one-story townhouse. A
move-in trailer behind it.

The family steps out.

BELINDA
The couch. Tell them to start with
the couch.

HENRY
Yeah, I know. I'm not going
anywhere.

Henry walks up to a group of men exiting the move-in
truck, and waves his hands.

Hazel holds Louis's hand as they stare into their new
home.

BELINDA
We are crunched for time, you know.
(MORE)

BELINDA (CONT'D)
We need to check the stove, the
toilet, the AC, groceries-

HENRY
How about this? First!

Henry points at all the furniture now being laid out on
the front yard.

Across the street, a labrador glances at them. JANE.

Jane sips tea, says nothing. Squints at them.

Henry protectively grabs Belinda's arm, but Belinda pulls
away.

While Louis and Hazel- their kids- hold hands, watching.

Hazel frowns. Then smiles to Louis.

HAZEL
Wanna play hide and seek?

Louis nods.

6 INT. LOUIS'S HOME - DAY

6

Hazel and Louis stand in the kitchen. Louis glances
around, takes it all in. Hazel turns Louis to face her.

A group of two men- large oxen- quietly move the TV in.
Then the couch.

HAZEL
Ready? One, two, three...

Louis runs to the bedroom as Hazel continues to count.
Movers place more furniture inside the house. A bed.

HAZEL
Seven, eight, nine, ten! Coming!

Hazel runs all the house, opening cupboards, coughing out
dust.

In the bathroom, at the mirror.

In the bedroom, at the closet.

Hazel opens it.

LOUIS
Rahhh!

Louis LEAPS at Hazel, tackling her. Hazel screams, then
giggles. He runs around the house.

HAZEL

Louis, I found you! You're it! Stop it! You're already it, stop running!

Louis and Hazel laugh and giggle, bumping into a wall. A newly-hung portrait falls. Henry catches it.

HENRY

Hazel!

HAZEL

Sorry!

BELINDA

Babe! Why are you hanging up- we can worry about the wall decorations later!

HENRY

Does it matter?

Louis bumps into Henry. He fumbles with the painting again.

LOUIS

Hehehe!

Belinda catches Louis into the air. Louis screams, then laughs.

BELINDA

TV?

Louis nods. Belinda turns to a panting Hazel.

BELINDA

Go.

Hazel goes solemn. Clears her throat. Nods.

Hazel and Louis hop on the couch. Hazel turns the TV on.

A local TV newscast for: TALENS.

REPORTER

For all tuning in, welcome to Talens.

A bull on TV.

REPORTER

We've seen animals of all kinds flocking to the city, a massive wave of migration, with the president himself backing the statistics.

A chart of job market growth in the next ten years, in various sectors.

REPORTER

30% increase in agricultural, 20 in service, 3 in fine arts, still higher than the national average-

LOUIS

Big sis? How come we're watching this?

HAZEL

Mom says it's important.

Henry grabs the remote and turns off the TV.

HENRY

She says a lot of things are important. Listen, I need you to do a favor for me, okay Hazel?

Hazel grunts.

HENRY

Can you go to the grocery store? And bring Louis, so he's not- you know, getting in the way.

HAZEL

But-

Henry hands a \$50 bill.

HENRY

It's around the corner.

(points)

Go two blocks that way, then turn right, you'll see it.

LOUIS

(gasps)

What do we get?

HENRY

Halibut, carrots, lettuce. Sorry, cabbage. Then get cooking oil, any kind, the cheapest.

HAZEL

Okay.

HENRY

Yeah? Louis, you okay with that?

Louis nods. Henry pats him on the back.

HENRY
Attaboy. Now don't get into trouble.

7 **EXT. LOUIS'S HOME - DAY**

7

Hazel and Louis walk down the street.

Cracked grass pokes out from underneath the ground.

HAZEL
So this is home now, huh? What do
you think?

LOUIS
It's really clean.

HAZEL
It's still kinda dirty... I got dust
all over my face.

LOUIS
Eugh! Maybe it is kinda dirty then.

HAZEL
Louis?

LOUIS
Yeah?

HAZEL
Are you scared?

LOUIS
Of what?

Hazel and Louis turn the corner. It's hardly a grocery
store.

It's more of a convenience mart, with metal bars around
the windows. And a wide parking lot.

8 **INT. CONVENIENCE MART - DAY**

8

Hazel enters the store. Behind the counter is a porcupine.

Louis stares at her. Hazel taps him on the shoulder.

HAZEL
(whispering)
Don't stare!

Louis takes Hazel by the hand and they head to the back.

Hazel approaches a small animal.

HAZEL

Excuse me? Excuse me! Can you help
me find the-

Several small animals duck around the corner. Hazel
scratches her head, sighs.

HAZEL

Come on. You get the carrots and
lettuce, I'll get the halibut.

Louis nods. He goes around the corner, searches. Grabs one
stock of carrots. More carrots. Then more and more. Too
much.

He doesn't forget to grab cabbage.

Meanwhile, Hazel searches for halibut. She watches a fox
search for it, waits for him to disappear, then grabs it.

At the counter, Hazel scans. The porcupine brushes her
bristles, but doesn't talk. Flips the tap-to-pay.

Hazel brings out cash.

The porcupine freezes- then nods, switching the \$50 bill
for equivalent change.

HAZEL

Do you live here?

Louis balances the carrots. They slip out of his hands.

HAZEL

L-Louis, that's too many! So
sorry...

The porcupine hands her \$10.

PORCUPINE

Leave 'em, I'll put 'em back.

HAZEL

Thanks.

Louis grabs the halibut, runs out of the shop. Hazel
follows him, laughing. The cashier cracks a slight smile.

9 **EXT. CONVENIENCE MART - DAY**

9

Hazel stares at the sky as they turn the corner, Louis
balancing the halibut, Hazel holding everything else.

HAZEL

I guess it's kinda nice.

LOUIS
What is she?

HAZEL
She's a porcupine.

LOUIS
And who was the guy grabbing a
carrot? With the big ears.

HAZEL
A rabbit. Don't say "big ears."

LOUIS
Why?

HAZEL
Just don't say it to them. 'Cause
you're making fun of them.

LOUIS
I'm not. I'm just saying.

HAZEL
You are.

LOUIS
(giggles)
No I'm not!

HAZEL
You're laughing! That's making fun
of them!

LOUIS
(laughing)
No I'm not! I'm not!

Louis runs.

HAZEL
Oh my god- wait! Louis!

10 INT. LOUIS'S HOME - NIGHT

10

The halibut SIZZLES on the grill. Blueberries are added to
a berry bowl.

The family plates the dishes on a wooden table. Hazel and
Henry sit down, sigh, call out:

HENRY
Louis! Hazel!

On the TV, a rally headlined: "PRESIDENT BULLOCK ON THE
GROWTH OF TALENS"

BULLOCK

I said that Talens is experiencing a
30% growth, what I didn't-

Voices raise in disapproval. A small newsroom of
reporters. Bullock raises his voice.

BULLOCK

What I didn't do is give permission
for every animal, big and small, to
flock to the cities seeking for
advantage of these opportunities.

The crowd cheers, but in the positive direction.

BULLOCK

We will ensure that anyone who
wasn't signed or contracted or given
proper work visas, whatever-
they'll- we'll- we'll get 'em.

The crowd roars. Henry turns off the TV, strokes his hands
through his hair. Belinda reaches to rub his shoulder- but
he flinches away this time. Belinda goes back to eating.

11 EXT. LOUIS'S HOME - NIGHT

11

The same labrador watching them earlier- Jane- sits on her
porch, squinting across the lawn.

She stares at the family of big animals.

She sits, as if protecting her fort.

She brings out a smoke and lighter, and takes a long drag.

HAZEL (V.O.)

What's left?

BELINDA (V.O.)

Get the rest of the halibut if you
want! I'm done eating.

HAZEL (V.O.)

Like, what's left of the move?

BELINDA (V.O.)

Oh.

HENRY (V.O.)

We have to mount the wall stuff.
We'll do that while you're at school
this week.

(clears throat loudly)

Louis, eat your vegetables.

LOUIS (V.O.)
But I don't wanna.

HAZEL (V.O.)
(grumbles)
Mom, Louis grabbed a ton of carrots
today. He dropped them on the floor.

HENRY (V.O.)
Louis!

LOUIS (V.O.)
(mumbling)
I like carrots! I don't wanna eat
the lettuce!

HENRY (V.O.)
Cabbage, Louis, it's cabbage.

LOUIS (V.O.)
Well, I don't wanna eat the cabbage!

HAZEL (V.O.)
Mom, he dropped them all over the
floor.

HENRY (V.O.)
Louis!

The family's yells grow louder and louder.

Jane gets up and finishes her smoke.

Then she gets up.

And SLAMS the door.

12 INT. LOUIS'S HOME - NIGHT

12

The yells stop. Their ears perked.

Belinda slowly gets up and closes the living room window.

BELINDA
Tomorrow, we're gonna get you both
registered, got it?

Louis and Hazel nod.

BELINDA
Henry?

HENRY
I know what to do.

Belinda tucks Louis and Hazel into bed.

LOUIS
 (whispering)
 Who was the big man on the TV, Mom?

BELINDA
 (whispering)
 Don't worry about it. Just sleep
 tight, okay?

LOUIS
 Okay.

Hazel turns away. Belinda turns to her, taps her on the
 shoulder.

BELINDA
 Night.

HAZEL
 (detached)
 Mm.

Belinda kisses Hazel on the cheek, then leaves.

The first night at home ends.

FADE TO:

PANG! PANG! PANG!

Louis opens his eyes. He sits up and glances to his right.

A black labrador- JUNIPER- is playing handball by the
 garage across from him.

He's Jane's kid.

BELINDA (O.S.)
 Louis! Hazel! Up!

13 INT. LOUIS'S CAR - DAY 13

Grey clouds pass overhead.

14 EXT. WESTSIDE PUBLIC ELEMENTARY - DAY 14

Belinda, Louis, and Hazel get out from the car.

15 INT. WESTSIDE PUBLIC ELEMENTARY - DAY 15

Belinda stands across a desk. The ASSISTANT is a mouse.

In the lobby, rabbits and porcupines play.

ASSISTANT
 Intake. Name, address, everything.

Slides the clipboard. Belinda swiftly signs it.

In the lobby, Louis watches two kids play. He tries to get up, but Hazel stops him.

BELINDA

Be good!

ASSISTANT

Right this way, please.

Belinda heads into a room.

ASSISTANT

You have their birth certificates?

Belinda brings it out, shakily. The assistant hands it back.

ASSISTANT

Income verification?

BELINDA

Me and my husband- we just moved here, so income will change.

Belinda slides work verification across the desk. She sits down in a small chair. She shuffles.

ASSISTANT

Coal mine and natural gas workers?
You from here?

BELINDA

No. Like I said, we moved-

ASSISTANT

Are you from here-here? This state.
This- you know, this province.

BELINDA

You can say the mainland. You can say that.

(sighs)

Yes, we're from a mining community off the coast. It's called Lakos. A lot of big animals like me live there.

(shrugs)

I hope that's not a problem.

The assistant straightens a stack of papers.

ASSISTANT

Not for us, it's just, you hear what the administration's doing?

BELINDA
Cracking down on big and small
animals?

ASSISTANT
Undocumented animals. Though yeah,
you could say that given the
numbers.

The assistant begins shuffling for papers.

ASSISTANT
Sorry. I just wanted to let you
know, there aren't many like you
here, and the architecture is
outdated.

BELINDA
That's fine.

ASSISTANT
It is more affordable than private
options, so there's that.

The assistant and Belinda have a chuckle.

BELINDA
Calling me broke?

No response. Belinda's smile fades. The assistant sits.

ASSISTANT
It is, you know, not great to have
your kid registered at a public
school for smaller... folks. We have
income, but it's not- we had a
long-time instructor quit this year.

Belinda shuffles in the tiny seat, clears her throat.

ASSISTANT
The government's trying to get
everyone integrated, but I don't
know, it's stressing out a lot of
our staff.

Belinda stands up.

BELINDA
You know what? I think-

The assistant holds out a document in the light, compares
it with another. There are differences.

Belinda breaks out into a sweat.

BELINDA
Um... Is everything okay?

The assistant squints at the paperwork. Then at Belinda.

BELINDA
Come on. Are you kidding me?

The assistant raises her eyebrows and sighs. Slides her paperwork back to her, then a contract.

ASSISTANT
You know what? Sign.

Belinda nods, signs it.

BELINDA
Have a good one, ma'am.

Belinda leaves the office. She grabs Hazel and Louis.

16 EXT. DOWNTOWN - DAY

16

Henry approaches a building. A worn down, freshly-leased building.

17 INT. TAILOR STORE - DAY

17

He heads inside. The OWNER, a raccoon, walks him through.

OWNER
We're still in hiring season, so
you're lucky. Here's the fabric we
work with-

Henry approaches the back.

OWNER
Then sewing machines in the front.
Any questions?

HENRY
Ready to start tomorrow. Excited to
work with you.

OWNER
Pardon, but...

The owner glances up and down Henry's frame.

OWNER
You good with those hands of yours?

HENRY
Oh, I'm great with 'em!

Henry and the owner chuckle.

OWNER
 Attaboy. And you said you wanted to
 check out the other side?

18 INT. SALON - DAY

18

OWNER
 You said your wife'll be working
 here.

HENRY
 Yeah.

OWNER
 She also good with her hands?

HENRY
 Runs in the family, what can I say.

The owner raises his eyebrows.

HENRY
 Runs in both of our families.
 Separate families.

The owner chuckles him off, pats him.

OWNER
 I'll see you tomorrow.

19 EXT. DOWNTOWN - DAY

19

Henry walks down the street with a sewing machine. He
 chuckles, pats the machine.

20 EXT. LOUIS'S HOME - DAY

20

Louis's family leave the car.

LOUIS
 Daddy!

Louis runs and hugs Henry.

Henry smiles at Belinda. She smiles back.

21 INT. LOUIS'S HOME - NIGHT

21

Hazel watches the news. "DEMOGRAPHICS CHANGES IN TALENS"

REPORTER
 Of the migrant groups, we're seeing
 bears, rabbits, beavers, otters,
 essentially anyone among the
 extremes. For those who have lived
 here for a long time- vulpines,
 (MORE)

REPORTER (CONT'D)
 felids, bovines, canines. In other
 words, dogs ad dog-derivative
 species. Monkey in the middle.

A diverse chart of many different species in the TALENS
 2012 CONSENSUS.

Louis yawns.

LOUIS
 I'm tired.

HAZEL
 Then go do something else.

Louis gets off the couch, wanders around the house. He
 jumps on the bed-

Then hears a ball dribbling.

PANG! PANG! PANG!

22 EXT. LOUIS'S HOME - DAY

22

On the porch across Louis, Jane's kid- Juniper- continues
 to play handball.

Louis arrives on the porch.

LOUIS
 (whispering)
 He's still playing?
 (loud)
 Hey!

The dog turns around.

LOUIS
 What's your name?

Juniper glances at him, then away.

PANG!

Louis waits. The ball PANGS again, against Juniper's
 garage.

Louis frowns, turns around-

But hears panting.

Juniper runs toward a ball on the side of the road. Louis
 watches, but his eyes widen.

It happens so fast.

A car HONKS.

Juniper reaches for the ball-

Louis gasps, dashing toward Juniper-

But the car STOPS just in time. Juniper frantically rushes back to his side.

DRIVER
Watch where you're going,
dogshitter!

The world goes quiet. The car drives off.

Louis's eyes are wide. He approaches Juniper, but Juniper gets up and runs. He bangs.

JUNIPER
Let me inside! Mom! Please!

The door opens. Juniper dashes inside.

Jane stares at Louis.

LOUIS
Wait! You forgot-

The door SLAMS.

Louis picks up Juniper's ball.

LOUIS
Your ball.

Louis stares out into the distance, at the random driver who yelled.

He approaches Juniper's porch and sits. He waits...

And waits...

And waits...

23 EXT. LOUIS'S HOME - NIGHT

23

Until the sun goes down.

BELINDA (O.S.)
Louis!

Louis sighs. He gets up and begins walking down the porch-

But glances at his ball and places it on Juniper's bench. The place where Jane sat.

Louis closes the door to his house. But the door opens to Juniper's.

Jane- his mother- steps out onto the porch with a smoke.

She sits right next to the ball, and listens to the family speak.

The wind blows. She brings out her phone. It goes straight to voicemail.

JANE
 Hey, babe. Juniper was playing
 today, and...
 (beat)
 Nevermind. I wanted to say I love
 you and miss you. Hope your brother
 isn't giving you a heart attack.
 Okay. Bye.

Jane ends the call. She stares at the family of bears running around.

She squints, but for a moment her gaze falters.

And it lands on the handball. She picks it up, then examines it.

And heads inside.

FADE TO:

24 INT. LOUIS'S HOME - DAY

24

Belinda and Henry get ready for work.

BELINDA
 How far of a walk is it? Should we
 just walk to work?

HENRY
 Took me 20 minutes from here, not
 that far. But still.

BELINDA
 But still.

25 EXT. LOUIS'S HOME - DAY

25

BELINDA
 Bye, kids! Take care of him, Hazel!

HAZEL
 I will!

The car drives off. Hazel turns to Louis.

HAZEL

Hey, Louis, wanna go around the neighborhood and look? I wanna see if we're the only bears here.

Louis, staring ahead, notices Juniper on the porch. Jane whispers something into his ear.

LOUIS

I'm okay.

Hazel notices Juniper's family, then glances back to Louis.

HAZEL

Now you're the one who's being no fun.

LOUIS

I'm not being no fun.

HAZEL

Yes you are, come on!

LOUIS

No.

HAZEL

Ugh! Whatever. I'll be back in like 40 minutes.

Hazel leaves. Louis sits alone at the porch.

Jane heads inside. Hazel disappears around the corner.

Juniper slowly, carefully, makes his way over. Louis gets up.

JUNIPER

Sorry.

Louis smiles.

JUNIPER

What's your name?

LOUIS

Louis.

JUNIPER

You have small ears.

Louis smiles. Then giggles.

JUNIPER

And I have big ears. And I have a long tail.

LOUIS
Mine is really short.

JUNIPER
It's kinda bushy.

LOUIS
(laughs)
Yeah, I guess.

Louis does a little dance. The two boys laugh.

JUNIPER
Wanna play?

Louis nods.

JUNIPER
Who's garage?

LOUIS
Does it matter?

Juniper goes up to the garage and bounces a ball. Louis catches it- volleys it back. The two bounce the ball, back and forth, laughing and giggling.

They fail to catch it. They chase after-

But a car swoops by.

This time, Louis blocks Juniper. Juniper bumps right into Louis.

Embarrassed, he pulls down his ears. But Louis turns around.

LOUIS
You okay?

Juniper nods.

The two of them grab the ball. They begin passing it back and forth.

LOUIS
Oh, by the way...

JUNIPER
Right! I keep forgetting. My name is Juniper.

Louis catches it.

LOUIS
Like the berry?

Juniper nods.

LOUIS
My mom says they're good for you.

Juniper catches it.

They smile. Then...

Juniper points to the door.

JUNIPER
Wanna hang out inside?

Louis nods.

The two cross the divider, and make their way into Louis's house.

Whatever nostalgic tune is playing ramps to its greatest note-

26 INT. BUS - DAY

26

Then subsides.

A rabbit, sitting in the bus, glances out the window, taller than her.

Out into the open sky.

She brings out her wallet. She checks for everything. Cards, cash, ID.

Then she lands on a strange polaroid photo. She takes it out.

EVE (V.O.)
Looking back, I wish you could have stayed away.

Her eyes well. The small rabbit tenses up, glances out the window again.

EVE (V.O.)
Away from the politics, school registrations, money-making salons.

Just before placing the photo back in her wallet, she takes one last look.

LOUIS and JUNIPER stand, alongside Eve, and two others- a beaver and an otter.

They're older, taller. Louis has his arm wrapped around Juniper.

EVE (V.O.)
So I'll tell it the way you want it.
I'll tell it with a thorn in your
side.

27 **EXT. BUS - DAY**

27

As the bus disappears into the horizon, away from a fading
Talens:

EVE (V.O.)
And when this is all over, maybe we
can meet together and laugh again.

CUT TO BLACK.